

Q3 Checkout Demand Forecast

Q3 2026 planning | Owner: Nora Vale, Checkout SRE | Next review: 2026-08-03

Decision at a glance

Decision

Fund an eight-pod weekday profile and preserve a ten-pod burst ceiling for September. The decision is driven by changing route composition rather than the July incident profile; mobile share and settlement lag are the governing indicators.

Planning peak

7,050 requests/s

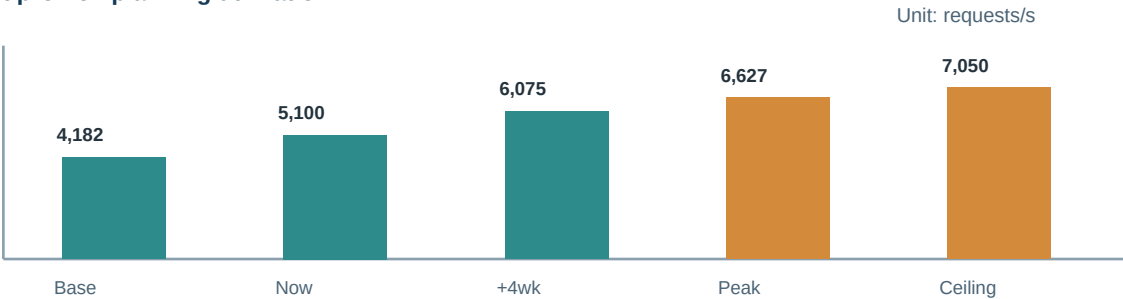
Evidence

Moderate; route-mix model with three release scenarios

Scope and assumptions

The Q3 forecast uses synthetic fare-release calendars, weekday commuter concentration, and an assumed 8% shift from kiosk to mobile checkout. It models a seven-day settlement cycle and reserves room for a September school-pass campaign. Fraud screening is represented as fixed CPU cost, not traffic.

Forecast profile - planning utilization



Capacity signals

Measure	Current	Planning limit	Decision signal
Forecast median	5,100 requests/s	7,050 requests/s	Fund eight pods when the August run-rate reaches 5,650.
Mobile route share	61%	<= 68%	Recompute pod mix if mobile rises faster than forecast.
Pod CPU p95	63%	< 72%	Ten-pod burst tier only when CPU remains below 72%.
Settlement lag	4.1 min	< 7 min	Lag rising with volume triggers batch tuning.

Plan, controls, and ownership

Action plan

Action	Due	Owner	Acceptance evidence
Reserve profile	Aug 01	FinOps partner	Book eight weekday pods through September.
Scenario refresh	Aug 03	Forecast analyst	Replace July route weights with observed weekly mix.
Burst test	Aug 18	Checkout team	Validate ten-pod activation under mobile-heavy demand.
September gate	Sep 01	Product ops	Confirm campaign slot before enabling cohort.

Risk register

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Response
Mobile adoption shift	Medium	Medium	Use route-level autoscaling instead of fleet-wide uplift.
Campaign compression	Medium	High	Move school-pass offers outside settlement close.
Fraud CPU inflation	Low	Medium	Track screening cost separately from request volume.

Decision rationale

Fund an eight-pod weekday profile and preserve a ten-pod burst ceiling for September. The decision is driven by changing route composition rather than the July incident profile; mobile share and settlement lag are the governing indicators.

Selective cross-references

Review alongside: Holiday readiness capacity review and the July Checkout SVC-17 review. These linked plans are relevant because they share a limiting dependency or coordinated operating window.

Model notes: all values are synthetic planning figures. No customer records, production identifiers, secrets, or routable network addresses are included. Northstar Transit Cloud | Forecast baseline: route mix v4